

AI Plant Observation Playbook

A practical workflow for photographs, manual records, AI prompts and evidence you can check.



The observation loop

01

Capture

02

Record

03

Organize

04

Review

01 One question keeps a session useful

Choose something visible and limited: Is the pale patch visible in both photographs? Which observations have a recorded unit? Avoid broad requests such as Tell me everything wrong with this plant. The wider the request, the more room there is for unsupported inference.

02 A complete loop

Capture an overview and a detail. Record the time, subject, tool and conditions. Ask AI to organize only those supplied facts. Review the output against the originals. Save the record and identify what remains unknown.

03 Your stopping rule

Stop when the next answer depends on a missing observation, an unreadable image or expertise outside the record. Mark that limit plainly. Keeping an unresolved question is more useful than saving a polished guess.

A FINISHED SESSION

ORIGINAL

Unedited evidence

DRAFT

Prompt + AI response

REVIEWED

**Checked record +
limits**

01 / Describe, then separate

01 When to use it

Use this for a first image review. Check that the output points to a visible feature and does not invent the subject history. If it names a diagnosis, remove that claim and ask for a neutral description.

02 Copy-ready prompt

You are organizing a plant observation record, not diagnosing or prescribing. Describe only visible features in the attached images. Separate: (1) visible observations, (2) uncertain interpretations, (3) missing evidence. Do not identify a cause, treatment or cultivation action. State unreadable details explicitly.

03 Add your evidence

Paste the packet or attach the original image copies after the prompt. A filename alone does not provide image pixels. Use only the necessary records for this question.

04 Review before saving

Match the output to your source. Keep unknowns visible; reject unsupported detail. Save the prompt, draft and your reviewed record as separate files.

FIELD RULE / Keep the original. Label what is unknown. Review before saving.

PROMPT WORKFLOW

INPUT

**Your limited evidence
packet**

TASK

**Describe, then
separate**

REVIEW

**Match every claim to
a source**

Your first complete session

01 Prepare

Choose P01 or another subject ID. Create a session folder. Write one limited observation question. Open the blank observation worksheet and keep the manufacturer manual nearby if recording a device.

02 Capture and record

Save an overview and a detail as originals. Copy any displayed reading with its unit, device, time and position. Add focus, lighting and settling limitations. Skip equipment fields when no equipment is used.

03 Organize and review

Use prompt 01 for image description or prompt 02 for notes. Check every claimed fact against the originals. Save unsupported fields as unknown, then use prompt 07 to create the journal entry.

04 Finish

Store the prompt and draft separately. Save the reviewed entry and update the CSV. Back up the folder. You are finished when the record is clear and its limits are explicit, even if the original question remains unresolved.

YOUR FINISH LINE

CHECK

Each fact matches a source

SAVE

Original + prompt + review

BACK UP

Folder + portable log